



USER GUIDE

Flight Briefing Assistant for iPad & Android

FLY INFORMED

A complete, plain-English guide to every tab, button and feature

FOR REFERENCE ONLY

Sky Matrix is a personal reference and situational-awareness aid. It is NOT an operational document. The official hard-copy OFP and approved company documents always govern flight operations.

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Edition: July 2026



1. Welcome to Sky Matrix

Sky Matrix is a single-screen assistant that turns your Operational Flight Plan (OFP) into an easy-to-read briefing and then stays useful for the whole flight — from engine start to on-blocks. You load your OFP once, and Sky Matrix pulls out the weights, fuel, levels, route, weather and NOTAMs, and gives you live in-flight tools: a UTC clock, timers, cabin announcements, an inflight-rest planner, a checklist, dangerous-goods data and more.

It runs in your web browser and can also be added to your Home Screen (iPad) or installed as an app (Android). Everything you type stays on your own device.

Important — read first: Sky Matrix is for reference and situational awareness only. It is not an operational document and must not be used to fly the aircraft. Always use the official hard-copy OFP and your approved company documentation for operations.

What you need

- An iPad (Safari) or an Android phone/tablet.
- A 30-day access code from your administrator (explained in Section 2).
- An internet connection the first time, and whenever you load a PDF, read live weather, or look up an aircraft. Most other features keep working offline once the app has loaded.

2. Getting access (your 30-day code)

Sky Matrix is protected. Instead of a shared password, each device is unlocked with a code that only your administrator can create. A code is tied to one device and is valid for a set period (usually 30 days), after which you simply enter a fresh code.

2.1 The lock screen and your Device ID

The first time you open Sky Matrix you see the lock screen with the Sky Matrix logo and a Device ID that looks like SKM-ABC123. This ID is unique to that device.

1. Note down your Device ID (or tap Copy).
2. Send it to your administrator and ask for an access code.
3. Your administrator generates a code for that exact Device ID and sends it back to you.

2.2 Activating

1. Paste the code into the box on the lock screen.
2. Tap Activate.

3. Sky Matrix opens and stays unlocked on that device until the code expires — you will not need to re-enter it every time.

Good to know: A code only works on the device it was made for. If you try it on a different phone or tablet it will say the code is not for this device — that is normal and by design. Each device needs its own code.

2.3 When your access expires

When the period ends the lock screen returns and says your access has expired. Send your Device ID to the administrator again, receive a new code, paste it and tap Activate. Your saved data and settings are untouched.

Tip: Connect to the internet at least once around renewal time. When online the app checks the correct date automatically so the days are counted fairly.

3. Installing Sky Matrix

3.1 iPad (Add to Home Screen)

1. Open the Sky Matrix web link in Safari.
2. Tap the Share button, then Add to Home Screen.
3. Name it Sky Matrix and tap Add. It now opens full-screen like an app.

3.2 Android

Sky Matrix can be installed as an Android app (an APK your administrator provides). Once installed it works like any other app, including offline, and it keeps the screen awake while open. GPS features need location permission — allow it when asked.

4. Finding your way around

4.1 The tab bar

Across the top are five tabs. The two most important — OFP Briefing and Inflight Display — are shown bold in the middle.

Tab	What it is for
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Load	Load your OFP, read a crew roster, write and translate announcements, and look up an aircraft.
OFP Briefing	The full briefing from your OFP: weights, fuel, levels, route, weather and NOTAMs.
Inflight Display	Your live in-flight screen: clock, timers, take-off/landing capture, announcements and arrival.
Checklist / DGR	Your editable checklist plus the Dangerous Goods emergency-response lookup.
Inflight Rest	Automatic crew rest-period planner.

4.2 The identity bar and live clock

Just under the tabs is a slim bar showing your flight call-sign, route and date, together with a live UTC clock that ticks every second. The clock reads true internet UTC time when you are online, so it stays accurate even if the device clock is slightly off.

4.3 Swiping and other controls

- Swipe left or right anywhere to move between the main tabs.
- **Whiteboard** — a floating pen button opens a full-screen notepad you can write or draw on with a finger or stylus (Pen, Eraser, Clear). Your notes are kept.
- **Alerts** — coloured strips appear for reminders (for example winds update due, or an approaching top-of-climb). Tap Acknowledge or Dismiss to clear them.
- **Screen** — the screen is kept awake while Sky Matrix is open, so it will not dim during use.

5. Load tab

5.1 Loading your OFP

1. On the Load tab, find the loader box.
2. Drop your OFP file onto it, or tap it to choose a file. Both PDF and text OFPs are accepted.
3. Tap Generate briefing. Sky Matrix reads the OFP and fills in every other tab.

To start a new flight later, tap Load another OFP. This clears the old flight and its captured times so nothing carries over.

Note: Reading a PDF needs an internet connection the first time (it downloads the PDF reader). After that

the app works offline.

5.2 Crew roster (OCR)

Upload a screenshot of your crew roster and Sky Matrix reads the names from the picture (OCR) and fills them into the announcements automatically. This needs internet. You can always type or correct names by hand.

5.3 My announcements and translation

- **My announcements** — a free-text box for your own personal PA notes. These are saved and can be reused.
- **Translate** — type or paste any text, pick a language from the list, and tap Translate to get a translation you can read to passengers. Needs internet.

5.4 Aircraft / flight lookup

Enter an ATC call-sign (for example ABC123) to fetch the airline, route and live aircraft details, or enter a registration (for example G-ABCD) to identify the aircraft type, manufacturer and operator. Tap Look up. Results come from Flightradar24, labelled as live or scheduled. This needs internet.

6. OFP Briefing tab

This is your full paper-style briefing, split into four sub-tabs: OFP, Route, Weather Alerts, and NOTAMs & Enroute.

6.1 OFP sub-tab

Shows the key numbers from your flight plan, laid out clearly:

- **Weights** — estimated take-off and landing weights against their limits. Figures are colour-coded — green with healthy margin, amber when the margin is small, and red if a limit would be exceeded. A line beneath compares your estimated landing weight to the maximum landing weight.
- **Fuel** — trip, taxi, reserve, alternate and total fuel, sized to fit even six-figure fuel loads (777 / A350).
- **Levels & performance** — planned levels, cost index, and the lowest tropopause along the climb shown next to the top-of-climb temperature.
- **Wind shear** — if the plan shows significant cruise-level shear, a wind-shear box appears here.
- **Remarks** — the free-text REMARKS block from your OFP is reproduced so you do not miss dispatcher notes.
- **Extra fuel** — the extra-fuel line is decoded into plain language (for example ETOPS, no alternate, MEL) so you know why fuel was added.
- **ETOPS** — entry, equal-time and exit points are labelled, keeping their real numbers where the plan provides them.

- **SID / STAR & EFB** — planned departure and arrival procedures, plus the current EFB update reference.
- **Crew info** — a tidy summary of crew and company bulletins, and any Special Crew Briefing that matches your route, departure, destination or alternates.

6.2 Route sub-tab

A readable list of your route: waypoints, tracks, distances and planned times, so you can follow the plan at a glance.

6.3 Weather Alerts sub-tab

Live weather and field information for your airports. Use the buttons to pull each item (needs internet):

Button	What it fetches
METAR / TAF	Current observation and forecast for the airport.
D-ATIS	The latest digital ATIS where available.
NOTAMs	Current NOTAMs for the airport.
Look up	Type any ICAO code to fetch weather, D-ATIS and NOTAMs for a field not on your plan.

6.4 NOTAMs & Enroute

Your departure, destination, alternate and enroute NOTAMs gathered together, with a raw-text fallback so nothing is hidden if a NOTAM has an unusual layout.

7. Inflight Display tab

Your live flight screen, with four sub-tabs: Departure, Live, Nav and Arrival. It moves with you through the flight.

7.1 Departure

Control	What it does
Engine warm-up	A 5-minute warm-up countdown to run at start-up.
BLOCKS OFF	Tap when you push/taxi to stamp your actual off-blocks time; it also starts the warm-up timer.

Welcome PA	Opens the Welcome announcement, pre-filled from your OFP and crew names (see Section 10).
DOCS	Your private document store — upload, open and delete PDFs kept only on this device.

The Departure card also holds your flight details (date, flight number, from/to, planned times, weights and stand/runway), which auto-fill from the OFP and can be edited.

7.2 Live

The heart of the in-flight screen:

- **Clock** — a large live UTC clock.
- **Times** — tap START at lift-off, or tap Arm GPS to let the app stamp take-off (and landing) automatically from GPS ground speed. A manual LDG button is there as a backup.
- **Counters** — elapsed time, time-to-go, ETA (UTC and local) and rest countdowns, all updating live. They show dashes until take-off.
- **Sun** — sunrise/sunset for departure and destination, plus day/night crossing points along the route.
- **Distance** — distance travelled so far.
- **Reminders** — reminder banners for events such as top-of-climb and fuel/cost-index checks; use Set reminder to add your own waypoint or time alert.

You can pull live METAR/TAF, D-ATIS and NOTAMs from this screen too.

7.3 Nav

Shows your next waypoint and compares your actual position, fuel and time against the OFP plan, so you can see if you are ahead or behind on fuel or schedule. You can pick any waypoint from the list, and Re-sync recalculates everything from your take-off time and the OFP.

7.4 Arrival

Control	What it does
Engine cool-down	A 5-minute cool-down countdown for after landing.
Descent PA	Opens the Descent/arrival announcement, pre-filled with arrival details (see Section 10).
STOP — on-blocks	Tap at the gate to stamp on-blocks time and calculate your total block time.

When you tap STOP — on-blocks an end-of-flight summary appears showing blocks-off, take-off, landing and blocks-on times, trip time, block time, distance travelled and the number of time zones crossed.

8. Checklist / DGR tab

8.1 Checklist

Your own editable checklist. Tick items as you complete them; use Add to create a new item and Reset ticks to clear all ticks for the next flight. Your list is saved on the device.

8.2 Dangerous Goods (DGR)

A quick emergency-response lookup. Choose the hazard class (1 to 12) and the drill letter, and Sky Matrix shows the matching ICAO emergency-response guidance for cabin/flight-deck reference.

9. Inflight Rest tab

Automatically builds your crew rest windows once take-off is captured. The rest period starts a few minutes after take-off and ends before top of descent. Choose a rest pattern (for example R/R, 2R/2R/R/R) and Sky Matrix lays out each crew member's rest slot and duration in a simple table.

10. Cabin announcements (Welcome & Descent)

Sky Matrix writes your PA for you. There are two: the Welcome announcement (opened from the Departure page) and the Descent announcement (opened from the Arrival page). Both open in the same window, already filled in from your OFP and crew details.

- Shared details — who is speaking, greeting, captain and crew names, aircraft type, flight number and destination — are entered once and used by both announcements.
- The Welcome PA adds flight time and cruising level; the Descent PA adds time-to-go, local arrival time and weather, and captures the landing and arrival times automatically as the flight progresses.
- A turbulence line is added automatically based on the wind-shear information in your OFP.
- Tap Copy to copy the finished announcement so you can read it or paste it elsewhere.

11. Handy extras

- **Accurate UTC clock** — reads true internet time, so it is right even if the device clock drifts.
- **Wind-update reminders** — a gentle prompt around 06/12/18/00 UTC to refresh winds.
- **Auto-save** — everything you type is saved on the device and restored automatically if the app is closed or reopened — including your loaded OFP.
- **Awake** — the screen stays awake while the app is open.

- **Print / Save as PDF** — produce a clean copy of your briefing to print or file.
- **Offline** — works offline once loaded, apart from features that clearly need the internet.

12. Limitations and cautions

Reference only: Sky Matrix must not be used to operate the aircraft. The official OFP and approved company documents always take priority.

- **Needs internet for** — reading PDFs the first time, live weather/D-ATIS/NOTAMs, aircraft look-up, roster OCR and translation. Everything else works offline once loaded.
- **Security** — access is a convenience lock, not high security. It is strong enough to keep casual users out, but a determined technical user could work around a device-side check. Use it sensibly and do not share codes.
- **Local times** — local-time conversions cover common regions and daylight-saving rules, but a few unusual time zones could be off by an hour; always cross-check against your OFP.
- **Route data** — automatic sun and enroute crossing points depend on the OFP providing clean waypoint positions and times.
- **GPS** — GPS take-off/landing capture needs location permission and a GPS fix (built-in or an external receiver). Manual buttons are always available as a backup.
- **Offline access** — a device that never connects to the internet cannot have its access period checked until it next comes online.

13. Troubleshooting

If you see...	What to do
"This code is not for this device"	Each code is tied to one Device ID. Send your own Device ID (shown on the lock screen) to the administrator and use the code made for it.
"Your access has expired"	Send your Device ID to the administrator for a fresh code, paste it and tap Activate. Your data is kept.
A PDF will not load	Check you are online (the PDF reader downloads once). If it is a scanned image, load the text OFP instead.
Weather / NOTAMs are blank	These need internet. Try again with a connection, or use the raw-text view.

Take-off time not captured	Tap START at lift-off, or tap Arm GPS and allow location. The manual field can be edited too.
Times look an hour out	Check the device date & time are set automatically, and cross-check local times against the OFP.

14. Quick reference — buttons at a glance

Button	What it does
Generate briefing	Read the loaded OFP and fill every tab.
Load another OFP	Clear the flight and start fresh.
Look up	Fetch aircraft / flight details.
Translate	Translate your announcement text.
METAR/TAF, D-ATIS, NOTAMs	Fetch live weather and field info.
BLOCKS OFF	Stamp off-blocks time; start warm-up.
START / Arm GPS / LDG	Capture take-off and landing (manual or automatic).
Set reminder	Add a waypoint or time alert.
Welcome PA / Descent PA	Open the ready-made announcements.
STOP — on-blocks	Stamp on-blocks; show the end-of-flight summary.
Add / Reset ticks	Edit the checklist / clear all ticks.
Whiteboard (pen button)	Open the notepad (Pen / Eraser / Clear).
Print / Save as PDF	Make a printable copy.



15. A typical flight, start to finish

1. Enter your 30-day code and open Sky Matrix.
2. On Load, drop in your OFP and tap Generate briefing.
3. Review OFP Briefing: weights, fuel, route, weather and NOTAMs.
4. At the gate, open Inflight Display then Departure. Tap BLOCKS OFF when you push, run the warm-up timer, and open the Welcome PA.
5. At lift-off, go to Live and tap START (or Arm GPS). Watch elapsed time, ETA, rest windows and reminders.
6. In the cruise, check Nav for fuel/time versus plan, and plan crew rest on Inflight Rest.
7. On descent, open Arrival, use the Descent PA, then run the cool-down after landing.
8. At the gate, tap STOP — on-blocks to record block time and see your end-of-flight summary.

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